

List of Google's special-case crawlers

The special-case crawlers are used by specific Google products where there's an agreement between the crawled site and the product about the crawl process. For example, AdsBot ignores the global robots.txt user agent (*) with the ad publisher's permission. The general [technical properties](#) (/crawling/docs/crawlers-fetchers/overview-google-crawlers#crawl-technical-props) of Google's crawlers also apply to the special-case crawlers.

The special-case crawlers may ignore robots.txt rules and so they operate from a different IP range than the common crawlers. The IP ranges are published in the [special-crawlers.json](#) (/static/crawling/ipranges/special-crawlers.json) object. The special-case crawlers' reverse DNS mask matches `rate-limited-proxy-***-***-***-***.google.com`.

The following list shows the special-case crawlers, their user agent strings as they appear in the HTTP requests, their user agent tokens for the `User-agent` : line in robots.txt, and the products that are affected by crawl preferences for the crawler. The list is not exhaustive, it only covers the requestors that are more likely to show up in log files and that we've received questions about.

Caution: The user agent string can be spoofed. [Learn how to verify if a requestor is from Google](#) (/crawling/docs/crawlers-fetchers/verify-google-requests).

APIs-Google (/crawling/docs/crawlers-fetchers/apis-user-agent)

User-Agent in HTTP requests	APIs-Google (+https://developers.google.com/webmasters/APIs-Google.html)	
robots.txt	User-agent token in robots.txt	APIs-Google
		The global user agent (*) is ignored.
	Example robots.txt group	user-agent: APIs-Google allow: /archive/1Q84 disallow: /archive/
Affected products	Crawling preferences addressed to the APIs-Google user agent affect the delivery of push notification messages by Google APIs.	

AdsBot Mobile Web

User-Agent in HTTP requests	Mozilla/5.0 (Linux; Android 6.0.1; Nexus 5X Build/MMB29P) AppleWebKit/537.36 (KHTML, like Gecko) Chrome/W.X.Y.Z (/crawling/docs/crawlers-fetchers/google-common-crawlers#user_agent_version) Mobile Safari/537.36 (compatible; AdsBot-Google-Mobile; +http://www.google.com/mobile/adsbot.html)	
robots.txt	User-agent token in robots.txt	AdsBot-Google-Mobile
		The global user agent (*) is ignored.
	Example robots.txt group	

```

user-agent: AdsBot-Google-Mobile
allow: /archive/1Q84
disallow: /archive/

```

Affected products

Crawling preferences addressed to the **AdsBot-Google-Mobile** user agent affect Google Ads' ability to check [web page ad quality](https://support.google.com/google-ads/answer/2404197) (https://support.google.com/google-ads/answer/2404197).

AdsBot

User-Agent in HTTP requests

AdsBot-Google (+http://www.google.com/adsbot.html)

robots.txt

User-agent token in robots.txt

AdsBot-Google

The global user agent (*) is ignored.

Example robots.txt group

```

user-agent: AdsBot-Google
allow: /archive/1Q84
disallow: /archive/

```

Affected products

Crawling preferences addressed to the **AdsBot-Google** user agent affect Google Ads' ability to check [web page ad quality](https://support.google.com/google-ads/answer/2404197) (https://support.google.com/google-ads/answer/2404197).

AdSense (https://support.google.com/adsense/answer/99376)

User-Agent in HTTP requests

Desktop agent

Mediapartners-Google

Mobile agent

```

(Various mobile device types) (compatible;
Mediapartners-Google/2.1;
+http://www.google.com/bot.html)

```

robots.txt

User-agent token in robots.txt

Mediapartners-Google

The global user agent (*) is ignored.

Example robots.txt group

```

user-agent: Mediapartners-Google
allow: /archive/1Q84
disallow: /archive/

```

Affected products

Crawling preferences addressed to the **Mediapartners-Google** user agent affect Google AdSense. The AdSense crawler visits participating sites in order to provide them with relevant ads.

Google-Safety

User-Agent in HTTP requests	Google-Safety
robots.txt	The Google-Safety user agent ignores robots.txt rules.
Affected products	The Google-Safety user agent handles abuse-specific crawling, such as malware discovery for publicly posted links on Google properties. As such it's unaffected by crawling preferences.

+ Retired special-case crawlers

The following special-case crawlers are no longer in use, and are only noted here for historical reference.

AdsBot Mobile Web

User-Agent in HTTP requests	Mozilla/5.0 (iPhone; CPU iPhone OS 14_7_1 like Mac OS X) AppleWebKit/605.1.15 (KHTML, like Gecko) Version/14.1.2 Mobile/15E148 Safari/604.1 (compatible; AdsBot-Google-Mobile; +http://www.google.com/mobile/adsbot.html)	
robots.txt	User-agent token in robots.txt	AdsBot-Google-Mobile
		The global user agent (*) is ignored.
Affected products	Crawling preferences addressed to the AdsBot-Google-Mobile user agent affected Google Ads' ability to check iPhone web page ad quality (https://support.google.com/google-ads/answer/2404197).	

Duplex on the web

User-Agent in HTTP requests	Mozilla/5.0 (Linux; Android 11; Pixel 2; DuplexWeb-Google/1.0) AppleWebKit/537.36 (KHTML, like Gecko) Chrome/86.0.4240.193 Mobile Safari/537.36	
robots.txt	User-agent token in robots.txt	DuplexWeb-Google
		Duplex on the web may ignore the * wildcard.
Affected products	Supported the Duplex on the web service.	

Google Favicon (/search/docs/appearance/favicon-in-search#crawler)

User-Agent in HTTP requests	Mozilla/5.0 (X11; Linux x86_64) AppleWebKit/537.36 (KHTML, like Gecko) Chrome/49.0.2623.75 Safari/537.36 Google Favicon	
robots.txt	User-agent token in robots.txt	Googlebot-Image
		Googlebot

Mobile Apps Android		
User-Agent in HTTP requests		
AdsBot-Google-Mobile-Apps		
robots.txt	User-agent token in robots.txt	AdsBot-Google-Mobile-Apps
		The AdsBot-Google-Mobile-Apps user agent obeyed AdsBot-Google (/crawling/docs/crawlers-fetchers/google-special-case-crawlers#adsbot) robots rules, but ignored the global user agent (*).
Affected products	Crawling preferences addressed to the AdsBot-Google-Mobile-Apps user agent affect Google Ads' ability to check Android app page ad quality (https://support.google.com/google-ads/answer/2404197).	

Web Light		
User-Agent in HTTP requests		
Mozilla/5.0 (Linux; Android 4.2.1; en-us; Nexus 5 Build/JOP40D) AppleWebKit/535.19 (KHTML, like Gecko; googleweblight) Chrome/38.0.1025.166 Mobile Safari/535.19		
robots.txt	User-agent token in robots.txt	googleweblight
		The googleweblight user agent was used only for explicit browse requests of a human visitor, and so it ignored robots.txt rules, which are used to block automated crawling requests.
Affected products	The Web Light user agent checked for the presence of the no-transform header whenever a user clicked your page in Search under appropriate conditions.	

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